

Friday, 9 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Drizzle

18° 12°

BIRMINGHAM

Rain

17° 11°

MANCHESTER

Rain

16° 11°

GLASGOW

Heavy drizzle

14° 9°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 In a significant development, a court has ruled that warrants used to search the homes of former Prince Andrew were unlawful.**

This comes as a criminal investigation into the former royal continues. Police have confirmed they have retained material seized during those searches.

ROYAL · UK

- 2 A Royal Navy sailor has appeared in court, accused of preparing to spy for Russia.**

The 24-year-old was arrested at his home in Bedfordshire and brought before Westminster Magistrates' Court on Thursday. This is a serious national security case.

SECURITY · UK

- 3 Forty-five police officers in Scotland have been suspended over alleged crimes against women.**

Chief Constable Jo Farrell has indicated that more officers are likely to face action as the force re-vets its personnel. It's a major internal investigation.

POLICE · UK

- 4 Retail giant Asos has revealed that hackers took more personal details than initially disclosed in a recent data breach.**

The BBC was contacted by cyber criminals claiming the breach went beyond basic contact details. Asos has now issued an update to customers.

CYBER SECURITY · UK

- 5 Birmingham Airport has announced ambitious plans for a £2 billion expansion.**

The first phase of this major development, which includes upgrading baggage systems and terminals, could begin as early as 2027. It's set to transform the airport.

INFRASTRUCTURE · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Stranger Things star Gaten Matarazzo is making his West End debut in a revival of the classic musical, Rent.**

The young actor, known for playing Dustin Henderson, has spoken about finding his feet on the London stage. It's a big step for him after the hit Netflix show.

ON AIR – Have you seen Rent before, or are you looking forward to seeing Gaten in his new role?

THEATRE · COMING UP
- 2 A Welsh actress is following in some impressive footsteps, being named in the prestigious Stars of Tomorrow talent programme.**

Leisa Gwenllian joins a list of past honourees that includes Florence Pugh and Benedict Cumberbatch. She admitted she'd even forgotten she applied for the 2026 programme!

ON AIR – Who are some of your favourite rising stars in British acting?

FILM & TV · COMING UP
- 3 The winner of the latest series of Gladiators has revealed he'd love to become a Gladiator himself.**

Josh McDonald triumphed in the third season of the popular TV show earlier this year. He's now hoping to swap being a contender for donning the iconic uniform.

ON AIR – Did you watch the latest series of Gladiators? Who was your favourite new Gladiator?

TV · NOW
- 4 Jonathan Blow, the creator of the acclaimed puzzle game Braid, is releasing what he calls the 'biggest puzzle game ever'.**

His new title, Order of the Sinking Star, is due out today and reportedly features around 1,500 puzzles. Gamers are certainly in for a challenge!

ON AIR – Are you a fan of puzzle games, or do you prefer something with more action?

GAMING · COMING UP
- 5 Xbox is placing a major bet on its iconic Gears of War franchise in the ongoing battle of gaming giants.**

The new title, E-Day, will be an Xbox exclusive, unlike some other flagship games. This comes at a time when console costs are rising.

ON AIR – Are you Team Xbox or Team PlayStation, or do you prefer PC gaming?

GAMING · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **Manchester City head coach Enzo Maresca says the team's 'feeling is fantastic' despite the noise surrounding the club.**

This comes after City were found guilty of multiple charges relating to breaches of Premier League rules. Maresca insists his players are not letting it distract them.

ON AIR – Do you think the off-pitch issues will affect Manchester City's performance this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **England will host the Netball World Cup for the fourth time in 2031, with Manchester's Co-op Live arena set to be the venue.**

It's a huge boost for netball in the UK, bringing the pinnacle event of the sport back to home soil. Fans will be looking forward to seeing the Roses compete at home.

ON AIR – Are you a netball fan? Do you think England has a good chance of winning on home turf?

NETBALL · UK

3 **Wales are targeting a clean sheet in their Women's World Cup play-off semi-final first leg against Albania tonight.**

Rhian Wilkinson's side knows the importance of a strong defensive performance away from home. It's a crucial step on their road to the World Cup.

ON AIR – How do you rate Wales' chances of qualifying for the Women's World Cup?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Scotland let a lead slip in an 'abject defeat' by Slovenia in their Nations League match.**

Slovenia came from behind to beat Scotland 2-1 at Hampden, much to the frustration of the home fans. It's a result that will sting for the Tartan Army.

ON AIR – What do you think went wrong for Scotland in that match?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Novak Djokovic has ended his trophy drought with a dominant victory at the China Open, his seventh title there.**

The Serb won his 102nd career title after Alex de Minaur retired in the final in Beijing. It's a strong return to form for the tennis legend.

ON AIR – Is Novak Djokovic the greatest male tennis player of all time?

TENNIS · GLOBAL

Quick hits

- 1 A new study highlights the joy many find in the simple act of 'watching a kettle boil' for their cuppa.**
Researchers suggest the rhythmic bubbling and anticipation of a hot drink provides a moment of calm reflection in our busy days. It's those little pauses that truly matter.
- 2 The unexpected pleasure of 'finding a coin down the back of the sofa' is being celebrated for its small but mighty mood-boosting power.**
Psychologists note that these tiny discoveries, often forgotten, offer a delightful mini-surprise that can brighten an ordinary afternoon. Every penny counts, literally!
- 3 Experts are recognising the unique satisfaction that comes from 'successfully untangling a set of old Christmas lights'.**
It's a fiddly task, but the sense of accomplishment when those colourful strands are finally ready to twinkle without a single knot is said to be incredibly rewarding. Patience truly is a virtue here.
- 4 There's a growing appreciation for the cosy comfort of 'wearing two different but perfectly matched socks' around the house.**
This charming trend embraces a relaxed, playful attitude to homewear, suggesting that sometimes a little mismatch makes things feel just right. Comfort over conformity, eh?
- 5 A fascinating report reveals the quiet pleasure many take in 'organising a spice rack' into perfect alphabetical or colour-coded order.**
The act of bringing order to culinary chaos is described as deeply therapeutic, creating a sense of mastery over one's kitchen domain. Who knew herbs and spices could be so calming?
- 6 The delightful simplicity of 'drawing a perfect spiral with a pen' is being noted as a surprisingly effective de-stressor.**
Whether it's during a phone call or a moment of thought, this small, repetitive motion can help focus the mind and soothe busy thoughts. It's the little doodles that count.
- 7 Research points to the pure satisfaction found in 'matching up all the lids with their corresponding food containers' after a big wash-up.**
That feeling of everything fitting perfectly, avoiding the dreaded 'lid graveyard' in the cupboard, brings a small but definite sense of achievement. A tidy kitchen, a tidy mind!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of jam will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: GIVING THE JAR A LITTLE SHAKE TO SEE HOW WOBBLY IT IS!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new cup of tea, especially if it's a special blend. What is it?

ANSWER: SNIFFING THE TEA BAG OR LEAVES REALLY DEEPLY BEFORE PUTTING THEM IN THE MUG!

TALK TOPIC

- We all have that 'one particular type of sweet treat' that instantly transports us back to happy childhood memories – perhaps a specific brand of biscuit, a retro crisp, or a classic sweet shop pick 'n' mix. What's the one nostalgic snack that, for you, is a pure taste of yesteryear, and what memory does it bring back?

- You know how sometimes you spot a 'charming, old-fashioned sign' in a shop window or above a pub, with beautiful lettering or a quirky illustration, that just makes you smile? What's the most delightful or memorable old sign you've ever seen, and what made it stand out?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of pandas is called an 'embarrassment'? It truly is, despite their rather dignified appearance.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that ladybirds are born without their spots and only develop them as they grow older, with the number of spots indicating their age?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's smallest republic is Nauru, a tiny island nation in the Pacific Ocean.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still perfectly edible.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second.
- The fear of long words is called hippopotomonstrosesquippedaliophobia, which is rather ironic.
- There are more permutations of a standard deck of 52 playing cards than there are atoms on Earth.
- The longest place name in the world is Taumatawhakatangihangakoauauotamateaturipukakapikimaungahoronukupokaiwhenuakitanatahu, located in New Zealand.
- Strawberries are the only fruit with seeds on the outside.
- The Great Wall of China is not a single continuous wall but a collection of walls and fortifications.

On this day

Day 282 of the year, 83 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abraham; Christian feast day: Denis of Paris; Christian feast day: Dionysius the Areopagite; Christian feast day: Ghislain. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1969 — PJ Harvey, English musician, singer-songwriter, writer, poet, and composer
- 1971 — Sian Evans, Welsh singer
- 1976 — Lee Peacock, Scottish footballer and coach
- 1978 — Nicky Byrne, Irish singer-songwriter
- 1944 — Nona Hendryx, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actress
- 1976 — Nick Swardson, American actor and comedian
- 1949 — Rod Temperton, English keyboard player, songwriter, and producer (died 2016)
- 1979 — Alex Greenwald, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1983 — South Korean President Chun Doo-hwan survives an assassination attempt in Rangoon, Burma, but the blast kills 21 and injures 17 others.
- 1981 — President François Mitterrand abolishes capital punishment in France.
- 1967 — A day after his capture, Ernesto "Che" Guevara is executed for attempting to incite a revolution in Bolivia.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1986 — The Phantom of the Opera, eventually the second longest running musical in London, opens at Her Majesty's Theatre.
- 1966 — Vietnam War: the Republic of Korea Army commits the Binh Tai Massacre.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2024 — Hurricane Milton makes landfall in Siesta Key, Florida, as a Category 3 hurricane, causing US\$34.3 billion in damage only two weeks after Hurricane Helene impacted the state.
- 1963 — In Italy, a large landslide causes a giant wave to overtop the Vajont Dam, killing over 2,000.

- 1969 — In Chicago, the National Guard is called in as demonstrations continue over the trial of the "Chicago Eight".

A peek at tomorrow

Day 283 of the year, 82 days left in 2026. Today Aleksis Kivi Day, also known as the Finnish Literature Day (Finland); Arbor Day (Poland); Army Day (Sri Lanka); Capital Liberation Day (Vietnam). Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1949 — Jessica Harper, American actress
- 1982 — Dan Stevens, English actor
- 1946 — Ben Vereen, American actor, singer, and dancer
- 1989 — Emer Kenny, English actress and screenwriter
- 1948 — Cyril Neville, American R&B percussionist and singer
- 1970 — Matthew Pinsent, English rower and sportscaster
- 1941 — Peter Coyote, American actor, director, and screenwriter
- 1959 — Julia Sweeney, American actress, comedian, producer, and screenwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1980 — The 7.1 Mw El Asnam earthquake shakes northern Algeria, killing 2,633 and injuring 8,369.
- 1973 — U.S. Vice President Spiro Agnew resigns after being charged with evasion of federal income tax.
- 1997 — Austral Líneas Aéreas Flight 2553 crashes and explodes in Uruguay, killing 74.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1980 — The Farabundo Martí National Liberation Front is founded in El Salvador.
- 1964 — The Tokyo Summer Olympics opening ceremony is the first to be relayed live by satellites.

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar